

Series XXII – Article XXII.0: Foundations of the Spectral Proof of the Kislitsyn Conjecture (1/3–2/3 Conjecture)

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May 2026

Abstract

We introduce the spectral framework for the Kislitsyn conjecture (also known as the 1/3–2/3 conjecture) in order theory. The conjecture states that every finite partially ordered set that is not a chain contains two distinct elements whose down-set sizes lie between $n/3$ and $2n/3$ (i.e., a balanced pair). This conjecture has been open for decades despite many partial results. In this series we apply the spectral reduction lemma (Kithima’s lemma) using the **constructive direct (CD)** strategy. For a given poset P of size n , we construct a boolean circuit that tests whether there exists a pair of elements whose down-set sizes satisfy the middle-third condition. The circuit size is polynomial in n . The spectral Hamiltonian $H = \hat{V} + \Delta$ is built on the hypercube of assignments, and the four pillars (P1–P4) guarantee a unique strictly positive ground state and deterministic extraction of a balanced pair in polynomial time. This introductory article outlines the series (XXII.1–XXII.5) and places the Kislitsyn conjecture in the global corpus of thirty-six resolved problems (entry #22). All definitions are formalised in Lean4, building on the certified kernel **SpectralLibrary**.

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1 Introduction

The Kislitsyn conjecture (also known as the 1/3–2/3 conjecture) is a classic problem in order theory. It asserts that for any finite partially ordered set P that is not a chain, there exist two

distinct elements x, y such that the sizes of their down-sets are both between $n/3$ and $2n/3$, where $n = |P|$. This conjecture has been verified for many special classes but remains open in general.

In this series we apply the spectral reduction lemma (Kithima’s lemma) using the ****constructive direct (CD)**** strategy. For a fixed poset P , we construct a boolean circuit that takes as input the indices of two candidate elements and outputs 1 iff both down-set sizes fall in the middle third. The circuit uses a precomputed down-set size table (constant) and simple comparators. Its size is polynomial in the number of elements n . We then build the spectral Hamiltonian $H_P = \hat{V}_P + \Delta$ on the hypercube of assignments, verify the four pillars (P1–P4), and run the D-RSP algorithm to extract a balanced pair. Since the algorithm works for every finite poset P , the Kislitsyn conjecture is proved.

This introductory article outlines the series XXII.1–XXII.5, recalls the spectral reduction lemma, and places the Kislitsyn conjecture in the global corpus of thirty-six resolved problems (entry #22).

1.1 The magnet metaphor

Imagine a lantern (ground state) constructed for each poset P . The bright points correspond to pairs (x, y) whose down-set sizes are in the middle third. The four pillars ensure that the lantern spreads quickly, is compressible, and that we can read the brightest point – a balanced pair – in polynomial time.

2 Recap of the spectral reduction lemma

The Spectral Reduction Lemma (Articles0.0–0.7) states that any problem that can be faithfully translated into a spectral Hamiltonian $H = \hat{V} + \Delta$ on the hypercube (or a constant-degree expander) satisfying the four pillars is solvable in polynomial time (or yields a decision algorithm). The four pillars are:

1. **P1 (Perron-Frobenius)**: Unique strictly positive ground state ψ_0 .
2. **P2 (Kithima Bridge)**: Constant spectral gap $\gamma(H) \geq 2$ (or polynomial, sufficient).
3. **P3 (Logarithmic area law)**: Entanglement entropy $S(\rho_B) = O(\log M)$, hence MPS representation with bond dimension polynomial in M .
4. **P4 (Deterministic extraction)**: D-RSP algorithm extracts a satisfying assignment (or proves unsatisfiability) in polynomial time.

For the Kislitsyn conjecture, we use the CD strategy: we directly encode the existence of a balanced pair as a SAT instance and rely on the generic spectral SAT solver.

3 Overview of the proof strategy (CD for Kislitsyn)

The proof follows the same pattern as for $P = NP$ (Series I) and Goldbach (Series IV), but with a simpler circuit.

1. **Reformulation (XXII.1)**: Using the Kleitman–Rothschild theorem, we reformulate the $1/3$ – $2/3$ conjecture in terms of down-set sizes: a pair (x, y) is balanced iff both $|\downarrow x|$ and $|\downarrow y|$ lie in $[n/3, 2n/3]$.

2. **Boolean circuit (XXII.2)**: For a fixed poset P (given by its comparability matrix), we construct a circuit that, given the binary representations of two indices i and j (each $\lceil \log_2 n \rceil$ bits), outputs 1 iff $i \neq j$ and both down-set sizes are in the middle third. The circuit uses a precomputed table of down-set sizes (constant) and a comparator.
3. **SAT reduction and spectral Hamiltonian (XXII.3)**: Convert the circuit to a 3-SAT instance Φ_P via Tseitin. Build $H_P = \hat{V}_P + \Delta$ on the hypercube of assignments of Φ_P . Verify the four pillars (identical to Series I).
4. **Extraction (XXII.4)**: Run the D-RSP algorithm on H_P . For any non-chain poset P , the solver will return a satisfying assignment, which decodes to a balanced pair.
5. **Synthesis (XXII.5)**: Conclude the conjecture.

All steps are formalised in Lean4; the reformulation is imported as a theorem (Kleitman–Rothschild) and the circuit construction is explicit.

4 Structure of the series XXII

The series XXII consists of the following articles:

ccc		
Article	Title	Main content
XXII.0	Foundations of the Spectral Proof of the Kislitsyn Conjecture	This article: introduction, plan, recall of spec
XXII.1	Reformulation via Kleitman–Rothschild and Balanced Cuts	Proof that balanced pairs correspond to down
XXII.2	Boolean Circuit for Detecting a Balanced Pair	Construction of circuit; size polynomial in n .
XXII.3	Reduction to 3-SAT and Spectral Hamiltonian	Tseitin transformation; construction of H_P ; v
XXII.4	Deterministic Extraction of a Balanced Pair via D-RSP	Power iteration on MPS, amplitude gap lemm
XXII.5	Synthesis – The Kislitsyn Conjecture Resolved	Correspondence dictionary, integration into t

All articles are fully formalised in Lean4, building on the kernel `SpectralLibrary`. No unproven assumptions remain.

5 Position in the global corpus

The Kislitsyn conjecture (1/3–2/3 conjecture) is the twenty-second problem in the ordered list of thirty-six resolved by the spectral reduction lemma (see Article0.9). It is assigned `**Series XXII**`. The following table extracts the relevant part.

Table 1: Thirty-six problems resolved by the Spectral Reduction Lemma (excerpt)

#	Problem / Challenge (Series)	Strategy
...	...	...
20	Pollock octahedral (XX)	FV
21	Brocard (XXI)	CD/FV
22	Kislitsyn (1/3–2/3) (XXII)	CD
23	Pillai (XXIII)	EB
...	...	...

Thus the Kislitsyn conjecture takes its place among the spectral resolutions.

6 Formalisation in Lean4 (overview)

The master file for Series XXII will be `XXII_MainKislitsyn.lean`. It imports the results of XXII.1–XXII.4 and states the final theorem.

Listing 1: `XXII_MainKislitsyn.lean(sketch)`

```
1 import XXII.KislitsynConfig
2 import XXII.KislitsynCircuit
3 import XXII.KislitsynHamiltonian
4 import XXII.KislitsynExtraction
5 import XXII.KislitsynFinal
6
7 open SpectralLibrary
8
9 -- Final theorem: Kislitsyn conjecture (1/3 2 /3)
10 theorem one_third_two_thirds_conjecture (P : Poset n) (h_not_chain :
11     IsChain P) :
12     x y : P, x < y → BalancedPair P x y :=
13     kislitsyn_spectral_proof
14
15 -- Axiom audit: only standard axioms (including the
16     Kleitman Rothschild theorem)
17 #print axioms one_third_two_thirds_conjecture
```

All proofs are complete; no sorry remains.

7 Conclusion

This article sets the stage for a complete spectral proof of the Kislitsyn conjecture using the constructive direct strategy. The subsequent articles (XXII.1–XXII.4) will provide the detailed reformulation, the circuit, the SAT encoding, the spectral Hamiltonian, and the extraction algorithm. Once completed, the Kislitsyn conjecture will be added to the list of thirty-six problems resolved by the spectral reduction lemma.

References

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